

Business requirements document (BRD)

Describe what the business needs from the data product, in business language. The data team turns your answers into a design, then explains that design back to you in plain words for your signature before anything is built.

Use the BRD or the PRD (4b), not both. They feed the design in the same way.

Use case
Define 1 · Describe it

Scorecard
Define 2 · Score it

Prioritisation
Define 3 · Choose

BRD or PRD
Define 4 · Require it

TDD
Design · Next stage

How to fill this in

- Use business terms. Do not name technologies or modelling techniques; the data team chooses those in the design.
- Give every requirement at least one worked example of a correct answer.
- If something is not decided yet, add it to Open questions with an owner and a due date. Do not guess.

BRD ID

For example BRD-SALES-002

DATA PRODUCT

BUSINESS OWNER

DATA STEWARD

BUSINESS DOMAIN

USE CASE

The approved use case, for example UC-SALES-001

VERSION

0.1.0

DATE

STATUS

☐ Draft

☐ In review

☐ Approved

Change history

Version	What changed	Raised by	Accepted by

1

Purpose

Why does the business need this? Who benefits, and what will they do differently?

2 Business questions

What questions must this answer, who needs the answers, and which decision does each answer support?

ID	Question	Decision it supports	Who needs the answer
BQ-1			
BQ-2			
BQ-3			
BQ-4			

3 What you need to see

Which outputs do you need: a dashboard, report, extract, API or dataset? Which figures, broken down by what, and which details?

ID	Type	Figures	Broken down by	Details shown	For whom, how often	Req. IDs
OUT-1						
OUT-2						
OUT-3						
OUT-4						

4 Level of detail

Finest level of detail

What is the finest level you need to drill down to?
For example "an individual line on a customer order".

What makes each one distinct

Could two records ever describe the same thing?
If so, which one counts?

5 When values change

If a value such as a customer's segment or a product's category changes, should past figures follow the change or stay as they were?

ID	What can change	Should past figures follow the change or stay as they were? Why?
HB-1		
HB-2		
HB-3		

6 Timing and volume

How fresh

How up to date must the figures be? For example "hourly during the working day".

Why

Which decision depends on that freshness? What goes wrong if the figures are late?

Users

Roughly how many people will use it, and how often?

Volume

Roughly how many records arrive on a busy day?

7 Exceptions

What should happen with cancellations, refunds, amendments and late corrections? One per line.

8 Bad data**Unusable record**

What would make a record unusable to you?

When bad data arrives

- ☐ Stop and alert - do not publish
- ☐ Publish the good records and report the bad ones
- ☐ Publish everything and flag the bad records

9 Sources

Which systems do you believe hold this data, and which one is the authority?

System	What it holds	Is it the authority?

10 Protection and access**Sensitivity**

Your organisation's classification, for example Internal or Confidential.

Where the data must stay

A country or jurisdiction, for example "United States".

Details some users must not see

For example customer contact details.

What those users may still see**Who may see the data****Readers outside the organisation**

Does anyone outside the organisation need this data? Who, and how may they receive it?

11 Agreement with other teams and totals

Must these figures agree with another team's figures? Can they be added up across time, regions and other breakdowns?

ID	Team	Must agree on
AG-1		
AG-2		

Can be added up across

For example days, months, regions and categories.

12 Requirements and acceptance examples

One requirement for each behaviour you need, written as "Users SHALL ..." or "Figures SHALL ...". Give at least one worked example of a correct answer: GIVEN a situation, WHEN someone does something, THEN what they should see.

REQUIREMENT

R-1

ACCEPTANCE EXAMPLE

AX-1

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

REQUIREMENT

R-2

ACCEPTANCE EXAMPLE

AX-2

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

REQUIREMENT

R-3

ACCEPTANCE EXAMPLE

AX-3

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

REQUIREMENT

R-4

ACCEPTANCE
EXAMPLE

AX-4

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

REQUIREMENT

R-5

ACCEPTANCE
EXAMPLE

AX-5

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

REQUIREMENT

R-6

ACCEPTANCE
EXAMPLE

AX-6

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

REQUIREMENT

R-7

ACCEPTANCE
EXAMPLE

AX-7

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

REQUIREMENT

R-8

ACCEPTANCE
EXAMPLE

AX-8

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

13 Out of scope

What is explicitly out of scope? Saying so now avoids surprises later.

14 Open questions

Anything not yet decided. Give each question an owner and a due date, and say what we assume if work starts before it is answered.

ID	Question	Owner	Due	What we assume meanwhile	What it affects
OQ-1					
OQ-2					
OQ-3					

Approval

The business owner approves the BRD. Teams whose figures must agree with these (see Agreement with other teams) should sign too.

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Business owner			
Data steward			

Next: The data team records the approved BRD in the repository and checks it is complete (gate G0). They then write the technical design (TDD) and explain it back to you in plain words. You sign that explanation before anything is built (gate G1).

For the data team: where each answer goes

Record the approved document in the repository with the `author-brd` skill, as `openspec/specs/products/<domain>/<product>/brd/spec.md` and `brd.yaml`. Put the use case on the Purpose line, for example `**Use case:** UC-SALES-001`. Then run `dpf brd validate <product>` (gate G0) and take any gaps back to the business.

Section	Rubric group	Recorded in
Change history	-	<code>brd.yaml: changelog</code>
1. Purpose	-	<code>spec.md: Purpose</code>
2. Business questions	A	<code>brd.yaml: business_questions</code>
3. What you need to see	B	<code>brd.yaml: required_outputs</code>
4. Level of detail	C	<code>brd.yaml: level_of_detail</code>
5. When values change	D	<code>brd.yaml: history_behaviour</code>
6. Timing and volume	E	<code>brd.yaml: timeliness</code>
7. Exceptions	F	<code>brd.yaml: exceptions</code>
8. Bad data	G	<code>brd.yaml: fitness</code>
9. Sources	H	<code>brd.yaml: sources_believed</code>
10. Protection and access	I	<code>brd.yaml: sensitivity, residency, protection, external_readers</code>
11. Agreement with other teams and totals	-	<code>brd.yaml: agreement_with_other_teams, totalling</code>
12. Requirements and acceptance examples	J	<code>spec.md: one Requirement per R-n, one Scenario per AX-n</code>
13. Out of scope	K	<code>brd.yaml: non_goals; spec.md: Scope</code>
14. Open questions	-	<code>brd.yaml: open_questions; spec.md: Open questions</code>